

HIRALENT

Monthly Progress Report

21 July — 20 August 2026
The first full month of work

70%

Overall project completion

5 of 9

Major stages fully finished & verified

30

Of 44 known problems fully resolved

47

Automatic quality checks now running

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A plain-language summary of everything completed, everything still to come, and an honest explanation of the revised launch date.

In one page

70% complete

Up from an assessed 40% when work began on 20 July 2026



This month we took Hiralent from an application that **could not even be built or run** to one that builds cleanly, runs end-to-end, is secured, is able to handle real numbers of users, has every user type's screens genuinely working, and can now take **real card payments**.

The work was deliberately done in order, from the foundations upward. You cannot secure an app that will not start; you cannot deploy an app that is not secure; you cannot take money on an app that is not correct. Five of the nine planned stages are now finished and independently verified. A sixth — real payments — is about two-thirds done.

153 → 0

Errors blocking the
server build

222 → 0

Errors blocking the
website build

7

Critical security
holes closed

70

Documented work
entries this month

The three things worth knowing

1. The product itself is in far better shape than a month ago.

Payments were completely fake — the "pay" button produced an invented receipt and no money ever moved. Real card checkout, real receipts, refunds, upgrades and plan limits are now built and tested. Security holes that would have let an outsider log in as any user, including your administrator, are closed. The app previously would have fallen over with a few hundred people using it at once; that ceiling has been removed.

2. The deployment date moved from the 10th to a revised window.

We committed to having it deployed by the 10th. It is the 20th and it is not deployed. We owe you a straight explanation, and Section 5 of this report gives one in full — including the attempt we made, what we found, and why we chose to stop rather than push through. Your public website is, however, **already live on your main domain today**.

3. The revised commitment: 10–15 days.

The remaining payment work finishes first, then we deploy once, properly — not a temporary test deployment that has to be torn down and repeated. Section 7 sets out the plan day by day.

Where the project stood a month ago

Before any code was changed, we spent the first day doing a complete, independent review of the entire application — every screen, every server function, every database table. The purpose was to replace assumptions with facts. That review is the honest baseline this report measures against.

The headline finding was uncomfortable but important: **the app looked roughly 75% finished, but was only about 40% ready to actually go live**. A great deal had been built; much of it was not connected, not secured, or not real.

Before and after

Area	On 20 July	Today, 20 August
Can it be built for a real server?	No. The website and the server both failed to build — 375 blocking errors between them.	Yes. Both build cleanly, every time, with an automatic guard that blocks any new error.
Payments	Entirely fake. The checkout invented a fake receipt; no money could ever be taken.	Real card checkout, receipts, refunds, upgrades, cancellations and plan limits. Final agency billing in progress.
Security	Anyone could have forged a login as any user, including your admin. A live API key was exposed in the code.	All critical holes closed and re-tested. Keys rotated. Every screen checks who is asking.
Handling real traffic	Would have seized up in the low hundreds of simultaneous users.	Database load problem removed and measured under stress. Further speed work is a later stage.
Does it work end-to-end?	Never once tested as a whole. Several screens looked fine but quietly did nothing.	Automatic tests walk the real journeys for all four user types on every build.
Unfinished features	Many buttons led to "Coming soon", blank pages, or fake data.	Every one of those dead ends is now either genuinely built or honestly removed.
Can it be deployed?	No packaging existed for the two main parts of the system.	Packaging, automatic release process and demo data are built. Final hosting setup remains.

Why we tell you the bad starting number

It would have been easy to report "80% done" at the start and quietly fix things. We chose to publish the real 40% instead, because every claim in this report is measured against it. When we say 70% today, that is 30 points of genuinely verified progress — not a re-labelling.

SECTION 3

Progress by area

The project is organised into nine areas of work, tackled in order. Each one has to be finished and independently verified before the next begins — this is what stops problems being buried under later work.

#	Area of work	What it means	Progress	Status
1	Foundations	The app builds and runs reliably on any machine, not just the developer's.	100%	Finished
2	Security	Nobody can get into an account, or see data, that is not theirs.	100%	Finished
3	Database & data	Data is stored correctly, loads fast, and survives real numbers of users.	100%	Finished
4	Correctness & wiring	Screens that looked like they worked but quietly did nothing — all fixed.	95%	Finished
5	Finishing the features	Every "coming soon" and fake screen made real, for all four user types.	100%	Finished
6	Real payments	Genuine card payments, receipts, refunds, plans and limits.	70%	In progress
7	Speed at scale	Staying fast with thousands of people using it at the same time.	15%	To come
8	Monitoring & reliability	Knowing immediately if something breaks, and recovering without losing work.	10%	To come
9	Going live	Putting everything onto real servers with your domain and certificates.	30%	Started

Known problems: found, fixed, remaining

The opening review catalogued 44 distinct problems, each ranked by how much damage it could cause. Here is exactly where they stand.

Severity	Found	Fully fixed	Partly fixed	Still to do
Critical — would stop launch	7	6	0	1 (<i>payments, in progress</i>)
High — serious	14	8	2	4
Medium	17	11	2	4
Low / housekeeping	6	5	0	1
Total	44	30	4	10

The 10 remaining items all sit inside the three areas not yet started (speed at scale, monitoring, and going live) plus the final part of payments. None of them are newly discovered — they were all identified on day one and scheduled deliberately.

What we completed this month

Six blocks of work, in the order they were done.

01 Making the application build and run at all

This sounds basic; it was the single biggest blocker. Neither half of the system could be prepared for a real server — the website had 222 blocking errors and the server 153. There were also two competing installation tools fighting each other, which is the classic cause of "it works on my machine but not on yours".

- All 375 blocking errors fixed properly — not hidden by switching off the safety checks.
- Several of them turned out to be real bugs waiting to happen: the "recommended jobs" screen, part of the CV upload, the "verifying your email" step and a photo-in-chat feature would all have failed for real users.
- Settled on one installation tool so every machine and the live server install exactly the same versions.
- Removed about 15 dead files and a duplicated password library that was a genuine hazard.
- Found and neutralised a configuration line that, in the wrong circumstances, could have **wiped the main database**.
- Ran the whole system together for the first time and proved a real sign-up and login works live.

02 Security

The review found several issues that individually would have been enough to stop a launch.

- **Anyone could have logged in as anyone.** The secret key used to sign logins was left at its factory default, publicly known. That means a stranger could have created a valid login for your administrator account. Rotated and locked down.
- **A live API key was sitting in the code**, visible to anyone with access to the project, and billable to you. Revoked and replaced with a secure setup.
- **Candidate code could escape onto the server.** The coding-test feature had a fallback that ran a candidate's submitted code directly on the main server. Closed, and later replaced with a properly isolated executor.
- **Private data was reachable without logging in** — CVs, code submissions, and a document-verification callback that could have been faked to approve identity checks. All now require proper authentication.
- **One candidate could view or edit another candidate's profile** simply by changing a number in the address bar. Fixed across every affected screen.
- **Sign-up allowed anyone to register themselves as an administrator.** Removed.
- Added standard web-security protections, request rate limits, shorter login lifetimes, and proper sign-out.

How we check ourselves

After each block of work we deliberately re-examine our own changes as if an outside auditor were trying to break them. That habit found and fixed a further 25 real issues this month that the original work had missed — including six ways money could have been manipulated once payments went in.

03 The database — making it survive real traffic

Every part of the server was opening its *own private line* to the database — in over 80 different places. A database only permits so many at once. The app was fine for a handful of people and would have seized up with a few hundred.

- Rewired the entire server onto a single shared, capped connection — and added an automatic guard so the old pattern can never come back.
- Proved it under stress: we fired dozens of simultaneous requests at the running server while counting the actual live connections. It held at the cap and never went over.
- Added 36 database indexes to the busiest tables so large lists stay fast as data grows — measured, not assumed.
- Added limits so a single request can no longer ask for the entire database at once.
- Fixed data-model faults: postal codes could not accept letters, qualifications were stored in three places that drifted apart, and deleting a user was blocked by 44 broken links between tables.
- Removed an unused database that the server nevertheless refused to start without.
- Made a brand-new database usable in one command — correct structure, an admin account, plans and starter data — which is exactly what a live deployment needs.

04 Fixing the things that looked like they worked

This category is the most dangerous kind of bug, because nothing shows an error — the screen simply does nothing, and users assume they did something wrong.

- **Users were being silently signed out roughly every 15 minutes.** The app was misreading the server's "here is your refreshed session" reply. Fixed.
- **The administrator's agency-approval screen was entirely non-functional** — it displayed, but approve, reject and list all failed silently. Fixed.
- **"Sign out of other devices" did nothing** — the feature was fully built but never connected. Connected.
- **Document-verification results were being sent to the wrong address** and quietly discarded. Fixed and proven end-to-end.
- **Chat had no live updates** for read-receipts and reactions — the server sent them, the app never listened. Now live, with read ticks.
- **Sign-up emails could fail silently**, leaving users stuck unverified with no clue why. Failures are now visible.
- **The app had the developer's local address hard-coded in about 47 files.** Moving to a real server would have meant hand-editing dozens of files. Now it is a single setting.
- Introduced one consistent way for the server to reply and to report errors, so a failure surfaces as a clear message rather than a blank screen.

05 Finishing the unfinished features — all four user types

The review listed every place a user could hit a dead end. Each was either genuinely built or honestly removed — nothing was left pretending.

User type	What was broken or fake	What it is now
Companies	"Publish job" did nothing. "Manage hiring" said Coming Soon. The Discover page showed made-up companies. Public company profiles were static placeholders.	All working against real data. Discover now lists genuine companies with a privacy-safe view. Duplicate half-built screens folded into the working ones.
Candidates	The analytics page said "coming soon". The practice coding screen used invented questions and a fake countdown.	Real analytics widgets, and the navigation link restored. Fake practice surfaces removed rather than left misleading.
Agencies	Notification settings appeared to save but were never stored — they reset on reload.	Genuinely saved, per user, and shared across companies and candidates too.
Administrators	Four sidebar links — Admins, Settings, Analytics and Security Log — led to missing pages.	All four built for real, including a working security audit trail and a platform setting that can switch new registrations on or off.

Alongside this we replaced simulated background functions with genuine ones: company verification now performs a real domain-ownership lookup and a real website check; the coding-test executor runs candidate code in a properly isolated container; and every place where the AI reads text from an outside source (a scraped website, an uploaded document) is now protected against that text containing hidden instructions designed to manipulate the result.

We also removed genuine duplication: there were three separate scoring engines that could disagree with one another about the same candidate. They now share one engine — and reconciling them exposed a real scoring bug that had been quietly producing wrong results.

06 Real payments — about two-thirds done

This was the single largest fake area of the product. The old checkout produced a made-up reference and a made-up receipt URL; no card was ever charged and no subscription ever really started.

- **Real hosted card checkout is live**, with prices taken from the database rather than trusted from the browser — so a customer cannot alter what they are charged.
- **Payment confirmations are cryptographically verified** before an account is upgraded, and recorded so the same confirmation can never be processed twice.
- **The full lifecycle works**: upgrade, downgrade with fair proration, cancel now or at period end, refunds, failed-payment handling and automatic expiry.
- **Plan limits are enforced for real** — job posting and AI interview allowances now come from the customer's actual plan.
- **Receipts cannot be altered or deleted**, enforced at the database itself, and a read-only reconciliation view lets you compare our records against the payment provider's.
- Payment methods we are not launching with are honestly disabled rather than shown as broken buttons.
- **Still to do**: billing for agencies (they have different needs from companies, so they get their own plans), and a final end-to-end money test.

The deployment date — what happened

We said deployment would be done by the 10th. It is the 20th and it is not done. That commitment was not met, and this section explains exactly why — without softening it.

What we actually tried

We did not simply let the date pass. Between the 15th and the 19th we opened a parallel track specifically to get the system onto a live test server *while* development continued, so that you could see and click through a working deployment. That track got a long way:

- The server was packaged for hosting for the first time (this had never existed).
- An automatic release process was written and proven on a fresh, empty database — it sets up the database, creates the admin account, and then *verifies* that it actually worked rather than assuming.
- A safe set of demo accounts was built so you could log in as each user type and try the product.
- Hosting credentials and a full click-by-click deployment guide were prepared.

Then we stopped, deliberately, and moved that work back to its proper place in the sequence.

Why we stopped — five honest reasons

1. Deploying half-finished payments is the one thing you cannot undo.

Payments are the area still in progress. A deployment made this week would have put partly-finished billing code onto a real server. The risk is not an ugly screen — it is charging a customer the wrong amount, taking money and not activating the account, or failing to refund. Those are mistakes that cost trust and money, and they are not fixable with a quick patch.

2. Deploying mid-development means deploying repeatedly.

The system is changing daily. A deployment made on the 10th would have been out of date by the 12th and wrong by the 15th. Each redeployment carries its own risk of breaking something. Doing it once, at the right moment, is both safer and cheaper than doing it four times.

3. The attempt surfaced real problems — which is exactly why it was worth doing.

- The server **refused to start at all** unless an optional background service was running — a fault that would have caused a total outage on the very first live deployment. Found and fixed.
- A settings file was one step away from having **live passwords committed into the project history**, where they are extremely hard to remove. Closed.
- The automatic coding-test feature **cannot run on ordinary hosting** — it needs a machine of its own. Discovered during this attempt, and I corrected my own earlier assurance to you on that point rather than letting it fail quietly later.

Had we pushed the deployment through on the 10th, the first two would have hit you on day one.

4. The starting point was materially worse than anyone knew.

The 10th was estimated before the full review existed. That review then found the app would not build, payments were fictional, and a stranger could log in as your administrator. Deploying to that date would have meant putting an insecure, non-functional product on your live domain. The right call was to fix the foundations first — and that is what the last month bought.

5. The work is not behind — the deployment was resequenced.

In the same month, five of nine areas were completed and verified, 30 of 44 known problems were closed, and payments went from entirely fake to genuinely working. The date moved because we reordered the last step, not because progress

stalled.

In the meantime, your public site is already live

The public-facing website is deployed and reachable on your main domain right now. What is pending is the full production deployment of the *system behind it* — the server, the database and the AI services — which is what makes the logged-in product work at scale.

Nothing built for the deployment attempt was wasted. The packaging, the release process, the demo accounts and the hosting guide are all finished, committed, and will be used as-is when we deploy for real.

SECTION 6

What is still to do

Item	What it involves	Effort	Priority
Finish payments	Billing for agencies on their own plans, and a complete end-to-end money test with a real test card.	2–3 days	Now
Speed at scale	Caching frequently-read data, making the AI services handle many requests at once, and allowing more than one server to run side by side.	3–4 days	Next
Monitoring & reliability	Alerts when something breaks, a proper log trail, no work lost when a server restarts, and automatic retries for failed background jobs.	2–3 days	Next
Full deployment	Live database, live servers, your domain, security certificates, automatic deployment, backups, and the separate machine for coding tests.	3–4 days	Final
Final acceptance pass	Walking every journey on the live system as a real user, for all four user types, before handover.	1 day	Final

SECTION 7

The plan to launch

Target: full production deployment within 10–15 days.

Window	What happens	What you will see
Days 1–3	Payments completed — agency billing plus the full money test.	A written confirmation that a real test payment completed, activated an account and refunded correctly.
Days 4–7	Speed and reliability work — caching, faster AI handling, alerting and crash recovery.	Load-test figures showing how many simultaneous users the system holds.
Days 8–11	Full deployment: live database, servers, your domain, certificates, backups, and the coding-test machine.	A working login link on your own domain, plus demo accounts for each user type.
Days 12–15	Acceptance pass and handover — every journey walked live, plus documentation.	Handover pack: admin access, operating guide, and the full technical record.

One commitment about this date

If anything threatens this window, you will hear it from us *before* the date, not after — with the reason and a revised plan. The last thing we want is for you to have to ask again.

SECTION 8

Please have this independently checked

We would genuinely welcome it. If you have access to a developer — or would like to appoint one — everything in this report is written down and independently verifiable. Nothing here relies on taking our word for it.

What to give them

What they should look at	What it will show them
The full work record	A dated, itemised log of every change made this month — what it was before, what we changed, why, and how it was proven. 70 entries.
The original review & problem list	The independent assessment written before any work started, plus all 44 catalogued problems ranked by severity, each marked with its current status.
The automatic check suite	47 automated checks that run against the real system. Ask them to run the suite — it either passes or it does not; there is no room for interpretation.
The project history	Every change is timestamped and attributed. They can see precisely what was done, and when.
The plan documents	The nine areas of work, their entry and exit conditions, and what each still owes.

Three questions worth asking them

- "Do the automatic checks actually pass when you run them yourself?"
- "Are the checks meaningful, or would they pass even if the feature were broken?" — we deliberately break each check when we write it, to prove it catches failures. Ask them to confirm that.
- "Does the work record match what is actually in the code?"

We will hand over the full technical record on request, at any time, without conditions.

SECTION 9

The month in numbers

Measure	Start	Now
Overall readiness to go live	40%	70%
Areas of work fully completed and verified	0 of 9	5 of 9
Known problems fully resolved	0 of 44	30 of 44
Critical security holes open	7	0
Errors blocking the server build	153	0
Errors blocking the website build	222	0
Separate database connections opened by the server	88	1 (capped)
Automatic quality checks running on every build	0	47
Database performance indexes on busy tables	0	36
Database structure upgrades applied	—	11 new
Documented work entries	0	70
Real card payments possible	No	Yes

In summary

A month ago Hiralent was an application that looked finished and was not. Today it is an application that builds, runs, is secure, holds real traffic, works for all four user types, and can take real money. What remains is speed, monitoring, and the deployment itself — and the groundwork for that deployment is already built and waiting.

We missed the 10th. We are not going to miss the next date, and you will hear from us before it if anything changes.

Prepared by Huzaifa Iqbal · Iqbal Technologies · 20 August 2026

The complete technical work record, the original assessment, the problem register and the automated check suite are available on request — and are yours to have reviewed by anyone you choose.